

Entrepreneurial Competencies and Skills of STCBF Seaweed Farmer Beneficiaries in Digos City, Davao del Sur.

MA. ERWYNNAH E. CARAOA, DBA
RHODA M. HILIS, MABM
ALJUN NILO, MBA

DAVAO DEL SUR STATE COLLEGE, DIGOS CITY

ABSTRACT

This study assessed the socio-demographic profile, farm profile, entrepreneurial skills, and entrepreneurial competencies of seaweed farmers in Digos City, Davao del Sur. Using a descriptive quantitative research design, the study gathered survey responses from 46 respondents. The data were analyzed through frequency, percentage, and weighted mean to determine the farmers' profile and the level of their entrepreneurial skills and competencies. Results showed that most respondents were male, married, and within the 41–50 age bracket. Most had reached the elementary level of education, earned less than Php 10,000 monthly from seaweed farming, operated at a micro-farming scale, owned their farm, and relied mainly on self-financing. The overall mean score for entrepreneurial skills was 3.94, interpreted as High, while the overall mean score for entrepreneurial competencies was 2.96, interpreted as Moderate. Among the skill areas, maintaining family and community relations obtained the highest mean score of 4.62, interpreted as Very High, while managing tools, equipment, and supplies received the lowest mean score of 3.48, interpreted as High. For entrepreneurial competencies, the highest was initiative with a mean score of 4.06, interpreted as High, and the lowest was seeking new business opportunities with a mean score of 1.67, interpreted as Very Low. These findings suggest that while seaweed farmers possess strong practical and social skills, they need further support in digital literacy, opportunity recognition, market access, innovation, and post-harvest handling. The study recommends targeted capacity-building activities, including entrepreneurial training, ICT adoption, financial management, marketing, and business expansion strategies.

Keywords: Entrepreneurial Skills, Entrepreneurial Competencies, Seaweed farmers, Punta Biao, Digos City, Philippines

SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth